

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

Right Now I'm Okay

A Grounding Journal for Anxious Minds



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · come back to now

WELCOME

Before You Begin



Anxiety is a time traveler. It drags you into next week's disasters and last year's embarrassments — anywhere but here, where you actually are.

This journal has one job: bringing you back to right now. Because right now — this exact minute, in this exact chair — you're okay. Maybe not perfect. But okay.

Use these pages when the spiral starts, or a little each day to train your mind toward the present. There's no wrong way.

And a caring note: if anxiety is running your whole life, you deserve more backup than a journal. A doctor or therapist can help — this works beautifully alongside them.

STARTING POINT

Meet Your Anxiety



Describe your anxiety like a character — when it shows up, what it says, what it feels like in your body. Getting to know it is the first step to talking back.

PART ONE

Coming Back to Now



*The present moment is the one place anxiety
has the least power. Practice arriving.*

Right now, in this exact moment, what is actually happening around you? Just the facts of the room.



Name five things you can see, four you can touch, three you can hear, two you can smell, one you can taste. Write them.



What is your body doing right now — jaw, shoulders, breath, hands? Just notice, no fixing.



In this present minute, what danger is actually here? Not predicted — present.



*What's one thing that's genuinely okay right now,
however small?*



*Finish this sentence ten different ways: 'Right now,
I am...'*



PART TWO

Talking Back to the Spiral



*Anxious thoughts are loud, not true.
Cross-examine them.*

What is the worry saying will happen? Write the prediction word for word.



How many of anxiety's past predictions actually came true? What really happened instead?



What's the evidence for this worry — and honestly, what's the evidence against it?



If the hard thing DID happen, what would you actually do? Walk through it — you'll find you have moves.



What would you tell your best friend if she brought you this exact worry?



What's a calmer, truer sentence you can trade for the anxious one? Write both, side by side.



PART THREE

Building a Steadier Life



*Grounding is a skill. Skills grow with small,
boring, repeated practice.*

When are you naturally most calm? What's happening in those moments that you could do more of?



What feeds your anxiety — certain feeds, people, habits, too little sleep? Name your fuel sources.

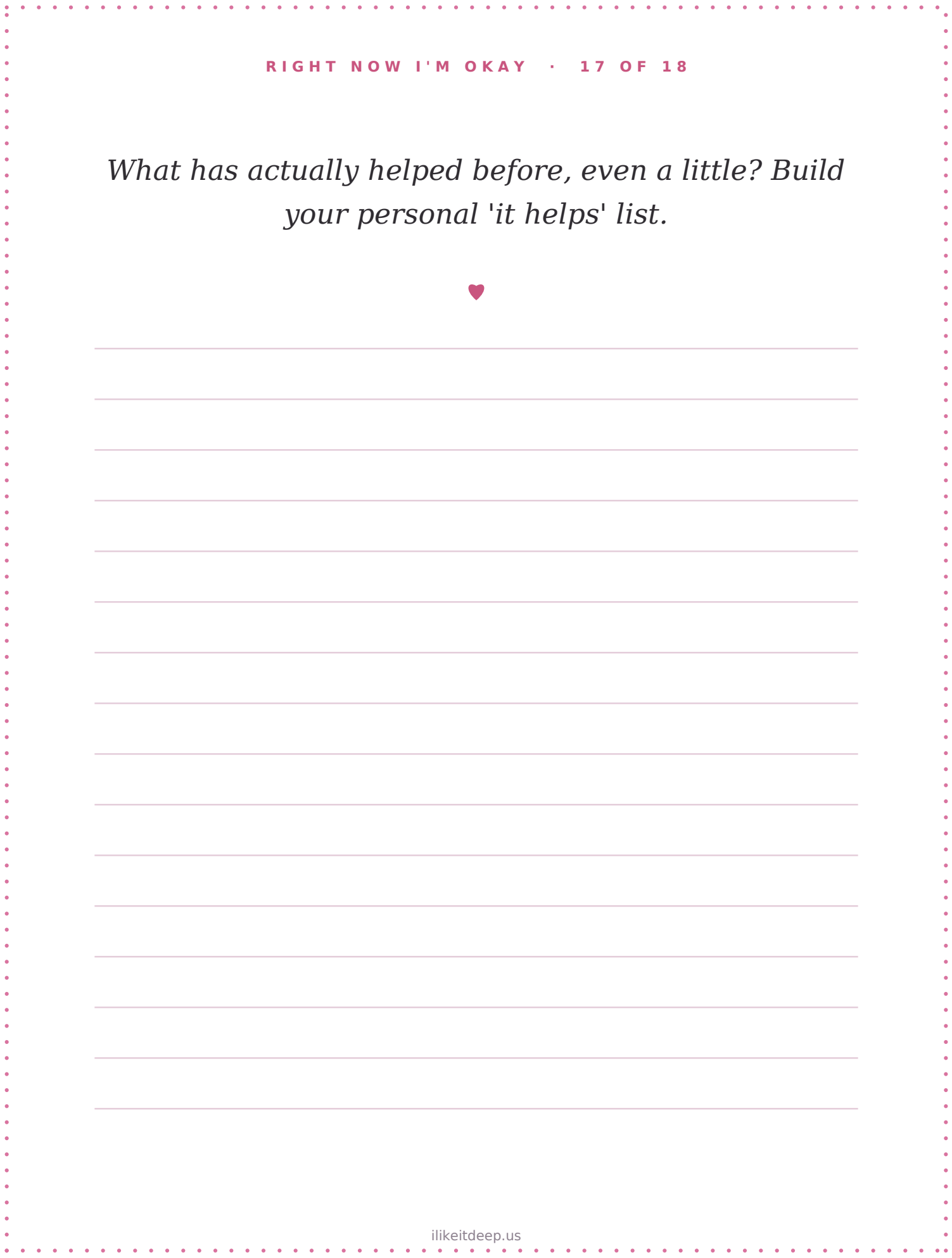


What daily anchors could steady you — a morning ritual, movement, real meals, a wind-down?



Who feels calming to be around, and how can you get more of those people?



[illegible][illegible]

*Write a note to yourself for the next anxious day.
Tell her what you know when you're steady.*



For the Spiral Moments



*When the wave hits, thinking is hard — so check your moves now
and come back to this page.*

- ☐ Feet flat on the floor — feel all four corners of each foot
- ☐ Breathe out longer than you breathe in, ten times
- ☐ Name what's around you out loud, like a tour guide
- ☐ Cold water on wrists or face
- ☐ Unclench: jaw, shoulders, hands — in that order
- ☐ Say: 'this is a feeling, not an emergency'
- ☐ Move for two minutes — walk, sway, shake it out
- ☐ Text someone safe: 'anxious moment, talk to me about anything'
- ☐ Do one small task with your hands — dishes, folding, watering
- ☐ Open this journal and answer one question

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

Times I Was Okay After All



Every worry that didn't come true, every wave you rode out — log it here. This page is your evidence file against anxiety's predictions.

♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	
♥	

BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



Anxiety will keep trying to time-travel you. That's its nature.
But you've now got something it hates: a way home to now.

Be patient with yourself. Grounding is a practice,
not a light switch — and every time you come back
to the present, the path gets more worn in.

And remember: needing more help than a journal
is not failing at calm. Doctors and therapists exist
because minds are allowed to need care too.



*Not perfect. Not forever. But right now?
Okay.*



ilikeitdeep.us · stay deep